

Chapter 36-5

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Liang Shi drove directly to the restaurant she and Xu Qingzhu had agreed on.

When she arrived, Sally and Cherry were also there, and Sally kept staring at her with very profound eyes.

Liang Shi felt uncomfortable being stared at and couldn't help asking, "Sally, is there something on my face?"

"No," Sally said. "Why did you come to eat near our company?"

Liang Shi: "...To supervise Xu Qingzhu."

Sally said matter-of-factly, "Cherry and I can do that too. Tell me, did you come because of that mistress?"

Liang Shi: "?"

Who?

Mistress?

She looked confused, and Xu Qingzhu coughed lightly beside her as a reminder, "Zhou Yi'an."

Liang Shi: "..."

Liang Shi rubbed her temples with a headache and picked up a piece of sushi that had just been served to give to Sally, "Please, Sally, spare me. Don't ruin my reputation."

Sally circled back to the question, "Then why did you come?"

And she analyzed confidently, "When the mistress doesn't come, you don't come. As soon as the mistress comes, you have to run over at lunchtime. If you say it's not because of the mistress, I don't believe it!"

"You're the mistress," Zhou Yi'an's voice suddenly rang out from behind, carrying a sinister tone that startled Sally.

Lin Luoxi turned around, her tone provocative, "Did we call your name?"

Zhou Yi'an clicked her tongue, "When you're talking about this in front of my darling, you're naturally talking about me."

Liang Shi: "...Shut up."

She looked at Zhou Yi'an expressionlessly, and Zhou Yi'an glanced at her then at Xu Qingzhu, "My darling really knows how to care for people."

Liang Shi raised an eyebrow and sneered, "Haven't gone crazy enough yet?"

Her tone of voice was nine-tenths similar to that night, and the smile on her face was the same as that night too, with a few traces of intense interest in her eyes, as if saying—if you haven't gone crazy enough, then I'll accompany you for another round of madness.

The fear of being dominated by Liang Shi that night, when she had pushed her down with her own hands, surged up from the depths of her memory.

Zhou Yi'an clenched her hands hanging at her sides into fists, "Darling, I'm not crazy."

"Then shut up," Liang Shi said. "Stop disgusting me, or I won't be able to eat later."

Zhou Yi'an: "..."

She looked deeply at Liang Shi, then smiled, "Fine, you all eat. I'm leaving."

After saying this, she looked at Sally again and threatened in English, "Watch what you say in the future. Don't slander people."

Sally was defiant, "But aren't you interfering in someone else's marriage?! Blanche and Liang Shi are already married. If your behavior isn't being a mistress, what is it?"

Zhou Yi'an paused for two seconds, her tone cold, "Only those who succeed in interfering are mistresses."

Sally: "?"

Zhou Yi'an sneered, "At most, I'm just toying with her."

Cherry: "..."

Lin Luoxi had originally taken a sip of orange juice, but upon hearing this, she spat it out. Sally immediately handed her tissues.

After Lin Luoxi wiped the water stains from the corner of her mouth, she said, "You're quite self-aware."

Before she finished speaking, Zhou Yi'an had already left.

She had just come to pack a box of sushi and then continued back to draw.

Sally and Cherry both stared at Xu Qingzhu, but Xu Qingzhu showed no reaction. Even though the atmosphere between them and Zhou Yi'an had just been full of sparks and lightning, ready to fight at any moment, Xu Qingzhu was completely unaffected. She had eaten six pieces of sushi and was still drinking miso soup.

Sally: "You really have a big heart."

Cherry: "Impressive¹."

Xu Qingzhu raised an eyebrow, took a tissue to wipe the corner of her mouth, "The group meeting starts at two."

The two who had been eating leisurely immediately started eating quickly.

But Sally ate a lot and didn't let that stop her from continuing to ask, "Liang Shi, do you and that Zhou Yi'an really have nothing going on?"

Liang Shi was helpless, "What could there be? I don't like her. Besides, I'm already married."

Sally asked, "Then who do you like?"

Liang Shi: "..."

She was silent for two seconds, then answered vaguely, "Whoever you marry, that's who you like."

Lin Luoxi stopped eating halfway through and put down her chopsticks, "That's fallacious reasoning."

Liang Shi: "..."

Then what else was she supposed to say?

"Can't you like our Zhu Zi?" Sally said. "You can't even firmly say you like Zhu Zi?"

"I can," Liang Shi said. "The person I like is..."

"Alright," Xu Qingzhu interrupted her, rescuing her from the situation, "Can't eating shut you all up? You're not eating, but Liang Shi still needs to eat."

Sally immediately turned sour, "We haven't even done anything to her yet, and you're already protecting her!"

Xu Qingzhu sat by the window, outside which were the towering CBD buildings reaching into the clouds. The glass was cleaned very thoroughly, and the afternoon sunlight streamed in, falling on her.

She half-closed her eyes to bask in the sun, her tone clear and cold, her speech slow but carrying a hint of teasing, "If I don't protect my wife, am I supposed to protect you?"

Sally clutched her heart, expressing her heartbreak.

Xu Qingzhu said airily, "Don't delay my wife's meal."

As she spoke, she used her chopsticks to pick up a piece of sushi for Liang Shi.

Liang Shi looked at the sushi on her plate and thought to herself: Xu Qingzhu's acting skills have improved by leaps and bounds.

She's at the level where she could enter the entertainment industry and be nominated for Best Actress any day now.

Footnotes: ¹ "Impressive" - The original Chinese "狼滅" appears to be internet slang, possibly a typo or variation of "厲害" (impressive/awesome)